

SKRULLS, THE

Shape-changing alien race

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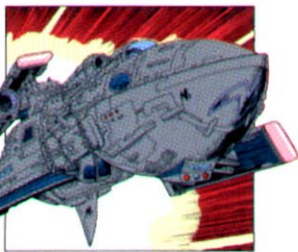
FACTFILE

BASE

Tarnax IV, Andromeda Galaxy

FIRST APPEARANCE

Fantastic Four Vol. 1 #2
(January 1962)



Skrull warships are designed to protect the paranoid species.

Shapeshifting permits radical changes in size, shape, and color; lifespans reach 200 years on average.

POWERS

THE KREE WAR

After forging an interstellar empire, the Skrulls encountered the primitive KREE, who murdered the Skrull contact team and stole their starship technology. A Kree armada soon attacked the Skrulls, triggering the cons-long Kree-Skrull War. Skrull scientists later developed the first Cosmic Cube, which gained sentence and decimated the Skrull Empire, eventually evolving into the exceptionally powerful SHAPER OF WORLDS. The Skrulls bounced back from this tragedy, establishing an Imperial throneworld on Tabrnax IV.

The Skrulls are an ancient humanoid species from the Andromeda galaxy, with reptilian physiologies. The cosmic beings known as the CELESTIALS visited the species' birthworld of Skrullos long ago and created Skrullian equivalents to Earth's ETERNALS and Deviants. The Deviant Skrulls exhibited the ability to shapeshift and soon wiped out all competing racial branches.



The Skrulls have taken a secret role in Earthly affairs, using their shapeshifting powers to impersonate world leaders.

SECRET AGENTS

The Skrulls placed agents on Earth, but these were defeated by the FANTASTIC FOUR. In response, the Skrull emperor Dorrek VII created the SUPER-SKRULL, who possessed the combined powers of the Fantastic Four. The Skrulls also engineered an elite class of Warskrulls, agents that could duplicate the powers of other beings when they assumed those beings' shapes. After GALACTUS devoured Tarnax IV, the Skrull Empire fell into civil war. The mad Skrull Zabyk detonated a hyper-wave bomb that removed the shapeshifting ability from all Skrulls. The Super-Skrull escaped the

Skrulls can alter their appearances to duplicate anyone, but can be shocked into dropping their disguises if they are hurt or knocked out.



bomb's effects and eventually managed to restore the species' shapeshifting powers.

During the Annihilation (see pp. 30-31), the Skrulls lost nearly all of their planets. The Skrulls turned to VIERANKE, who had been banished for supporting prophecies of just such an event, and made her their queen. Relying once more on the prophets, she decided to infiltrate and conquer the Earth, making it the new Skrull homeworld. When the attack began in earnest, this became known as the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7). The people of Earth banded together to root out the Skrulls and repel their attack, leaving the Skrulls nearly destroyed and homeless once more. **DW, MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• **Avengers #89-97** The devastating Kree-Skrull War reaches Earth, and the Avengers assemble to prevent innocents from being caught in the crossfire.

• **Avengers Annual #14** The insane Skrull warrior Zabyk detonates a hyper-wave bomb, removing the shapeshifting abilities of all Skrulls.

Secret Invasion #1-8 The Skrulls invade Earth.